

In 2050, you will not care what the market did in April 2025. The short term always seems to get in the way of the long term. I've heard countless stories from investors who panicked out of the market at the March 2009 lows and never found their way back in. They missed out on a huge climb in value. That's not sticking to a plan, and it's not what good financial planning looks like.

Don't rely on gurus, shamans, or talking heads

They haven't the slightest idea about your financial needs, your risk tolerances, your tax bracket, or anything else about you. I have been doing financial TV and radio for more than 20 years and have met many of these people. Very few have the slightest idea what they are talking about, and their general advice is for entertainment purposes only. Their forecasts are nothing more than marketing. Treat them that way.

Do notice your own state of mind

Are you agitated, freaked, stressed out? Is the market keeping you up at night? Notice the subtle difference between reacting emotionally to external stimuli and that nagging feeling that you forgot something important. At times, your body may be telling you something. Is your portfolio in sync with your own risk tolerance? Are you carrying more exposure to high-risk assets than you are comfortable with? Have your circumstances changed, but your portfolio has not? Try to be perceptive to when your subconscious is trying to get you to notice something. It could be important.

Don't take action while in a state of discomfort

Decisions made to *stop the pain* are the ones you will regret. The time for action is when you are in a thoughtful, calm state of mind. Any significant financial decision you make should be circumspect, carefully considered, and according to plan. If you are merely reacting to the latest market moves,